

ANDORRAEDIT

One of the most interesting places in Europe is the easy-to-get-to Andorra, which is a country with a tiny population that explodes during the winter months. This week we're talking to Joachim Thomas, who is the director, the commercial director, of Andorra Tourism. Joachim, welcome to the program.

Thank you very much. Now, Joachim, tell us a bit about Andorra, where it is, how people can find it and, you know, some of the great things you have to offer. Okay, Andorra is a very tiny country located in Europe.

We're just nestled between France and Spain. Our country is, as I said, quite small. It's 468 square kilometers.

We have around 70,000-75,000 inhabitants, but we are a country that receives lots of tourism. So we are receiving more than 8 million persons per year, different nationalities. Unfortunately, we do not have an airport, but we can use our nearest airports that are located in France and Spain.

That would be Barcelona. It's one of the biggest international airports in Spain. It's very well accessible for any country that would like to visit us.

There is also the Toulouse airport on the other side, on the French side. That also is a little bit smaller, but a very, very nice airport. Andorra is a country that is quite known for its winter, as a winter destination.

So we have two big ski resorts, and we have more than 300 square kilometers of slopes. And it's a good thing that the weather is quite nice weather, so we can have being skiing almost in short sleeves. So that's very nice.

Our season will be starting beginning of December and will finish around the end of April. So we have around, more or less every year, around between 130-150 skiing days. We receive something like 2,500,000 skiing days per year, so that's quite a lot for a small country as we are.

But we are here also to promote winter, as I said, but we would like to make people know that Andorra is an all-year-round destination. And we have very nice summer conditions. It's quite hot during the day, but it gets really fresh at night.

So it's very nice, and you can sleep quite well. You don't need to be air-conditioned or anything like that. Andorra, we have more than 70 lakes.

Our highest point is near 3,000 meters. It's the peak of Coma Pedrosa, that is 2,942 meters high, will be the highest point. And we have more than, almost the average of the peaks is over 2,000 meters.

And the language, it's very easy for an English speaker to get around Andorra, isn't it? Because a lot of people speak English and they don't really have to know French or Italian. Well, the official language, the unique, only official language in Andorra is Catalan, but almost everyone speaks Spanish and French, and English is well spoken. As a local, what are some of your favorite things, say, events that happen through the year? Tell us a bit about those.

Well, as I said, skiing, it's a nice thing, but we have lots of cultural events. We are working to bring more events in Andorra. Last year, we had Cirque du Soleil.

We had 10 presentations of Cirque du Soleil Andorra. We are working to have it next summer again, and that will be the main attraction next year again. How can people find more information about Andorra online? You can visit our new website.

It's visitandorra.com.